INCH - POUND

A-A-59768
16 March 2005

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

# PALLET, CARGO, INTERMODAL, ASSOCIATE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. The Associate Intermodal Pallet (hereafter called AIP) will be used in conjunction with the standard 463L Cargo Nets, Pallets and associated material handling equipment. Troops requiring cargo transport will load/band cargo on the AIP. The AIP will be delivered to the aerial port. Then the AIP will be loaded and "netted" on the 463L Pallet for transport throughout the military airlift system which includes cargo loaders, forklifts, and conveyor systems. The cargo aircraft include the C-130, C-5, and C-17.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Safety. The AIP shall be capable of operation within the accuracies, limits, and specifications herein. The pallet shall comply with OSHA and all other applicable standards in effect at the time of manufacture.

2.2 Environmental requirements. The AIP shall operate as specified herein in any ambient temperature from -25°F to +125°F. The AIP shall operate in high humidity and will be exposed to moisture. The AIP shall be operated in dusty and sandy environments. The AIP shall be exposed to ultraviolet light. The AIP shall operate in locations with insect infestations.

2.3 Materials. The materials shall be as specified herein. Materials not specified shall be selected by the contractor and shall be subject to all provisions of this specification.

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to WR-ALC/LEEV, 295 Byron St., Warner Robins AFB, GA 31098-1611 or email robert.david@robins.af.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at http://assist.daps.dla.mil .



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2.3.1 Recovered materials. The components, pieces and parts incorporated in the AIP may be newly fabricated from recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, provided the AIPs produced meet all other requirements of this specification.

2.3.2 Dissimilar metals. Unless suitably protected against galvanic corrosion, dissimilar metals shall not be in intimate contact with each other.

2.4 Drain holes. The AIP shall be designed to eliminate pockets where debris, insects and water might accumulate. All configurations shall have adequate sized and placed drain holes.

2.5 Plastic. The AIP shall be constructed using a commercially available plastic capable of meeting the performance requirements of this specification. The plastic shall be capable of contact with common industrial chemicals without degradation.

2.6 Protective treatment. When materials are used in the construction of the AIP that are subject to deterioration when exposed to climatic and environmental conditions likely to occur during service usage, they shall be protected against such deterioration in a manner that will in no way prevent compliance with performance requirements of this specification. The use of any protective coating that will crack, chip, or scale with age or extreme of climatic and environmental conditions shall be avoided.

2.7 Flammability. The AIP shall be made of a fire retardant or slow burn material in accordance with UL 94.

2.8 Rated capacity. The AIP shall have a rated capacity of 6,000 pounds with a minimum factor of safety of 1.5 (i.e., the design load shall be 9,000 pounds minimum). The rated load shall be uniformly distributed over the surface of the AIP. The rated load shall be a rectangular cube and shall be uniformly loaded. The rectangular cube shall be approximately 80 inches wide by 100 inches long by 80 inches high. The load center shall be 40 inches vertically from the bottom surface.

2.9 Maintainability. The AIP shall be capable of all maintenance and repair techniques normally performed on the manufacturer's standard commercial pallets.

2.10 Reliability. The AIP shall be constructed to assure optimum service life under all service conditions. The AIP shall be designed for a life of ten years and for a minimum of ten trips. One trip is defined as moving cargo from one location to another with an average of five handlings. When loaded to its rated capacity, the AIP shall be capable of withstanding a minimum of ten two-mile trips by forklift over a graded gravel road with no sign of degradation.

2.11 Overall dimensions and weight. The AIP shall be 82 inches by 102 inches (+ 0.25 inches, - 0.00 inches for each dimension). Minimum thickness of the AIP shall be 5.50 inches; maximum thickness shall be 10.00 inches. The AIP shall weigh 250 pounds maximum.

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2.12 Forklift tine pockets. The AIP shall have two forklift tine pockets on each side extending completely through to the other side. The pockets shall be designed to allow the AIP, loaded to its rated capacity, to be lifted and carried by a forklift from any side. Each pocket shall be a minimum of 4.00 inches high by 10.00 inches wide. Each pocket shall be lined to prevent excessive wear when meeting the requirements in this specification.

2.13 Storage. The AIPs shall be stackable to a minimum of 110 inches high for storage.

2.14 Data plate. A corrosion resistant plate shall be permanently installed in a visible protected location. The data plate shall contain a Unique Identifier (UID) bar code according to MIL-STD-130. The following information shall be on the plate:

a. Unique Identifier bar code
b. Asset NSN number
c. Payload, maximum (lbs)
d. Contract number
e. Date of manufacture

2.15 Automatic identification tag. When specified (see 6.2), a passive radio frequency identification tag shall be permanently installed on the AIP. The tag shall comply with MIL-STD-129. At a minimum, the tag shall transmit the UID information.

2.16 Marking. Each AIP shall have "Property of U. S. Air Force - Return to the nearest Air Force Base" in 1 inch high block letters on two visible surfaces.

2.16.1 Information aids. All stencils, decals, pates or other similar items that are provided on the manufacturer's standard product shall be included on the AIP. This shall include, but not be limited to: rated capacity, all cautions and warnings, and all references to safety related items.

2.17 Color. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the final color shall be yellow for safe operation in an indoor environment.

2.18 Tie-down provisions. The AIP shall have provisions to secure cargo. The manufacturer shall choose the appropriate tie-down provisions (e.g. banding and shrink wrap). The tie-down provisions shall restrain the design load statically in all horizontal and vertical directions. If the manufacturer's standard tie-down provisions meet the performance requirements of this specification and the manufacturer's tie-down process is documented, then the manufacturer's tie-down provisions may be used.

2.19 Workmanship. The AIP and all sub-components shall be fabricated in a thoroughly workmanlike manner. Particular attention shall be given to freedom from blemishes, burrs, defects, and sharp edges; accuracy of dimensions, radii of fillets, and marking of parts and assemblies; alignment of parts; tightness of fasteners; et cetera. The AIP shall be thoroughly cleaned of all foreign matter.

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## 3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR). However, used, rebuilt or remanufactured components, pieces, and parts shall not be incorporated in the AIP.

## 4. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commericial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.1.1. Inspection responsibility. The contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspections and testing specified herein, at his own or other facilities of his choosing. Government representatives shall witness all testing specified in Section 4 of this document.

4.2 Responsibility for compliance. All pallets on the contract shall meet all requirements of this document. The contractor shall comply with all requirements of this document, whether or not there is a corresponding inspection requirement in Section 4 of this document.

4.3 First production demonstration and test. When specified (see 6.2), the first production demonstration AIP and its components, contractor drawings and literature, and vendor literature shall be compared to this document to verify compliance. The AIP shall then be subjected to the demonstrations and test specified in 4.3.1 through 4.3.9.

4.3.1 Demonstrations and test. The following demonstrations and tests may be performed in any order, as determined by the contractor. The AIP shall be examined to determine compliance with this document. Occurrence of any of the following conditions during the testing specified herein shall be cause for rejection of the AIP:

a. Inability to meet specified performance requirements or inability to complete any test.
b. Permanent deformation, warping, malfunctions, or evidence of impending failure.
c. Temporary warping of the pallet in excess of 2.0 inches.
d. Any binding, jerking, or uneven operation of any component.
e. Excessive wearing, galling, gouging or other material removal.
f. Any condition which presents a safety hazard to personnel during operation, service or maintenance (e.g. static electricity, sharp corners, etc.).

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4.3.2 Demonstration conditions. Demonstrations requiring temperature adjustment shall be conducted as specified. Remaining demonstrations shall be shall be conducted at the ambient temperature and climatic conditions existing at the place of demonstration. All distance and time measurements, and other required data obtained during the testing shall be recorded and included in the report.

4.3.3 Environmental test. The AIP shall be subjected to environmental tests shown below (see 2.2).

4.3.3.1 High temperature test. The AIP with rated load shall be placed in an ambient temperature of at least 125 degrees Fahrenheit for at least two hours or until the AIP stabilizes at the ambient temperature. Forklift the loaded AIP up to five feet and pause for five minutes. Measure the maximum pallet deflection between the fork tines. Then lower the loaded AIP back to rest on the ground. Repeat this cycle nine additional times. Remove the load and inspect. Any evidence of conditions mentioned in 4.3.1 shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.3.2 Low temperature test. The AIP with rated load shall be placed in an ambient temperature of no more than -25 degrees Fahrenheit for at least two hours or until the AIP stabilizes at the ambient temperature. Forklift the loaded AIP up to five feet and pause for five minutes. Measure the maximum pallet deflection between the fork tines. Then lower the loaded AIP back to rest on the ground. Repeat this cycle nine additional times. Remove the load and inspect. Any evidence of conditions mentioned in 4.3.1 shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.4 Capacity test. The AIP shall be capable of supporting the design load (see 2.4). The AIP shall be placed on a smooth and level ground surface. The design load shall be placed on the AIP. Forklift the loaded AIP up to five feet and pause for five minutes. Lower the AIP to ground level at maximum forklift lowering speed. Repeat this cycle nine additional times. Any evidence of conditions mentioned in 4.3.1 shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.5 Reliability test. The AIP with rated load shall be moved at least ten trips. One trip is defined as moving cargo from location one to location two with an average of five handlings. A handling shall be defined as the insertion and removal of fork tines. The forklift's travel path from location one to location two shall be at least two miles. The terrain shall be a graded gravel road. Inability to meet the requirements (see 2.6) or any evidence of conditions mentioned in 5.3.1 shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.6 Dimensions and weight test. The AIP shall be measured and weighed to determine compliance with the dimensions and weight requirements (see 2.7).

4.3.7 Forklift tine pockets test. The AIP forklift tine pockets shall be measured to determine compliance with the dimensional requirements (see 2.8).

4.3.8 Storage. The AIPs shall be stacked 110 inches high. Inability to meet the requirements (see 2.9) or any evidence of conditions mentioned in 4.3.1 shall be cause for rejection.

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4.3.9 Tie-down provisions test. The AIP with the design load shall be secured using the manufacturer's tie-down provisions. Slowly lift the AIP with the design load to simulate loading in the forward, rearward, lateral and vertical directions. For example, lifting the loaded pallet upside down will simulate a vertical load on the pallet. Inability to meet the requirements (see 2.14) or any evidence of conditions mentioned in 4.3.1 shall be cause for rejection.

## 5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation, Packaging and Marking. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the items shall be packaged according to normal commercial practice and packed to assure acceptance by common carrier and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipment, handling, and storage. Shipping containers shall be properly marked and in compliance with both national and uniform motor freight classifications.

## 6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The Associated Intermodal Pallet (AIP) is intended for use in handling cargo in and around warehouses, loading platforms, and docks; on paved or other hard surfaces

6.2 Ordering data.

a. Automatic identification tag, if required (see 2.11)
b. Color, if different (see 2.13)
c. First production demonstration, if required (see 4.3)

6.3 Source of documents.

6.3.1 Military Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks referenced herein may be obtained online at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/ or from the Standardization Document Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

6.3.2 Underwriters Laboratories (UL) copies may be obtained online at http://ulstandardsinfonet.ul.com/ or from: COMM 2000, 1414 Brook Drive, Downers Grove, IL 60515-5000.

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Military Interest

Custodians:
Air Force - 99

Civil Agency and
Coordinating Activity:
GSA-FSS

Preparing Activity:
Air Force - 84

Agent:
Air Force - 99

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